

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Searching For Life On Another Planet

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Scientists are studying an _____, a planet outside our own solar system.
2	TRAPPIST-1e is described as a _____, so it has an Earth-like physical nature.
3	In terms of scale, it is a _____ to Earth.
4	Its position is promising because it lies in the _____ around its star.
5	Researchers are examining the planet's _____.
6	They have rejected the idea that the atmosphere is mainly full of _____.
7	This matters because hydrogen and carbon dioxide are _____.
8	If those gases dominated, they could make the planet _____.
9	Early evidence suggests there may be a _____.
10	If there is enough nitrogen, it may help keep the planet at a _____.

11 **What is the main reason scientists are interested in TRAPPIST-1e at this point?**

- A It is known to contain alien organisms.
- B It has several Earth-like features in a life-supporting region.
- C It is the closest planet to the Earth.
- D It has already been proven to have liquid oceans.

12 **In the discussion, what does "exoplanet" refer to?**

- A A planet that has no atmosphere.
- B A star system with several rocky planets.
- C A planet that is too far away to observe.
- D A planet outside the solar system we belong to.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **Which atmospheric possibility have scientists largely dismissed?**
- A The planet is packed with hydrogen or carbon dioxide.
 - B The planet has no gases around it at all.
 - C The planet is mostly covered by nitrogen ice.
 - D The planet's air is identical to Earth's.
- 14 **Why would large amounts of hydrogen or carbon dioxide be a concern?**
- A They would prevent scientists from using models.
 - B They would make nitrogen impossible to detect.
 - C They could make the planet excessively warm.
 - D They would prove that the planet has no sunlight.
- 15 **What can be inferred from the mention of a nitrogen-dominated atmosphere?**
- A Scientists have confirmed advanced life there.
 - B It is one possible sign that the planet may be habitable.
 - C It means the planet must be colder than Earth.
 - D It rules out the need to study other gases.
- 16 **When the programme says the atmosphere has "potential", what is being emphasised?**
- A It is already proven to host living things.
 - B It has no scientific value unless nitrogen is found.
 - C It is too unstable to be studied properly.
 - D It may have the capacity to support life in the future.
- 17 **How is "data has potential" different from "potential data" in the explanation?**
- A The first suggests present usefulness; the second points to possible future usefulness.
 - B The first refers to old research; the second refers to failed research.
 - C The first is about gases; the second is about temperatures.
 - D The first is informal; the second is scientifically incorrect.
- 18 **Why is nitrogen treated as exciting in the discussion?**
- A It is the only gas that can exist around planets.
 - B It guarantees that the planet is exactly like Earth.
 - C It may indicate life and habitability.
 - D It makes the planet impossible to heat.

19 **What would scientists likely do if nitrogen were found?**

- A Stop studying the planet's atmosphere.
- B Send people to measure the surface directly.
- C Ignore the planet's temperature.
- D Examine other gases and model the planet's warmth.

20 **What would a suitable temperature and enough nitrogen mean for the search for life?**

- A It would move scientists one stage nearer to finding life.
- B It would immediately end the search successfully.
- C It would show that all exoplanets are habitable.
- D It would prove that greenhouse gases are always harmful.